

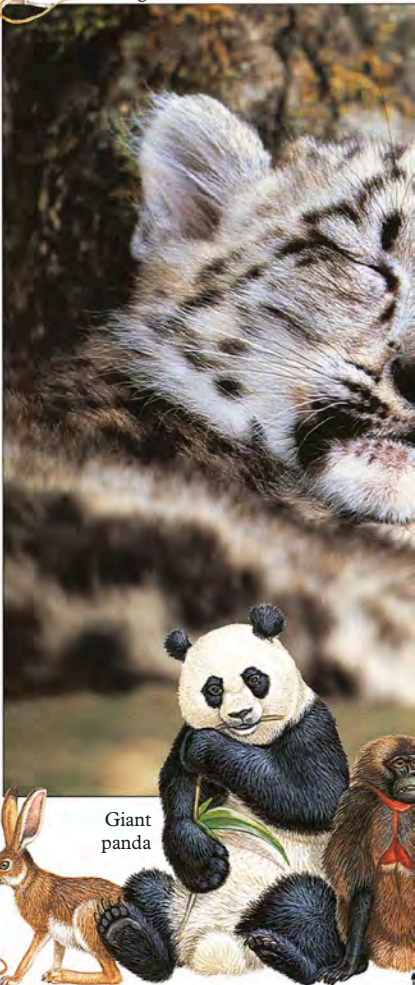
MAMMALS

Mammals are amazing animals. Some climb trees, others race across the ground, burrow, or even fly. Seals and otters are examples of mammals that live in the water. Mammals come in many shapes and sizes—a giraffe is tall, a mouse is small, and a platypus looks like an otter with a duck's beak. So what makes them all mammals? They are hairy, they breathe air into lungs, and they feed their babies milk.

Mammals are warm-blooded, which means their temperature is controlled by their bodies. Most are born live, not hatched from eggs, although platypuses lay eggs. Marsupials are a special kind of mammal because they give birth to babies that are only half formed. These tiny creatures grow into adults nestled in a warm safe pouch on their mother's body. Many mammals eat only plants, while others eat meat or insects. You are a mammal, too.



Pale kangaroo mouse



Black-tailed jack rabbit

Giant panda

Golden mouse

Gelada



Platypus